



Is the Strategy Against the **NAXALS** Working?

The BEST warns the Government that its hardline Naxalite policy should not escalate into military action. It wants the focus to also be on strengthening local governance.



Ajit Kumar Doval: I don't think the Government is going about it right. They are giving an impression that they are going to conquer their own land and vanquish their own people. The message that should go out is that we are supporting development and meeting the needs of the people. We will reinforce it security-wise so that they can get schools, roads and hospitals. Just as we asked the ITBP to make roads in Afghanistan we are sending 70,000 CRPF troops to ameliorate the conditions of the people and save the tribals from exploitation.

Satish Nambiar: I am happy the political establishment wisely refrained from using the armed forces because it would be a sad day if our armed forces have to fight our own civilians. The air chief seeking permission to use force lowers the performance of the armed forces. When you are given a job you have to defend yourself. The capacity of local forces and police should be enhanced by lateral induction of retired armed force personnel. You should have people who have the capability to deal with insurgency.

Ved Marwah: The Government till recent times was trying to tell the Indian public that Naxal violence was no problem at all. Our previous Home Minister was playing with statistics to say that the number of police stations affected is hardly 4 or 5 per cent of the total. Tomorrow they will produce statistics to prove only 0.1 per cent

VILLAGERS GATHER AT AN
INDOCTRINATION CAMP